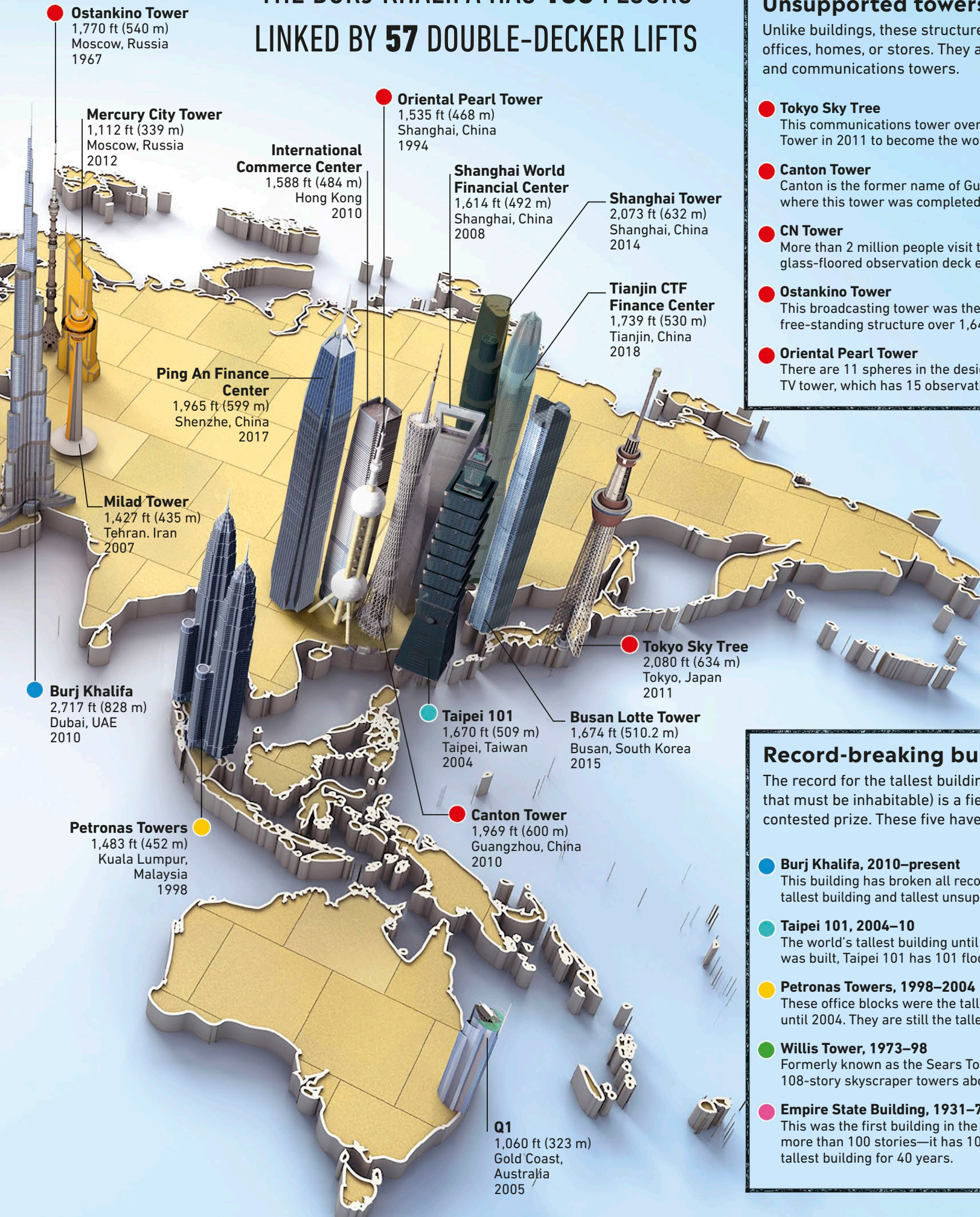


THE BURJ KHALIFA HAS 163 FLOORS LINKED BY 57 DOUBLE-DECKER LIFTS



Unsupported towers

Unlike buildings, these structures don't contain offices, homes, or stores. They are observation and communications towers.

• Tokyo Sky Tree

This communications tower overtook the Canton Tower in 2011 to become the world's tallest.

• Canton Tower

Canton is the former name of Guangzhou, where this tower was completed in 2010.

• CN Tower

More than 2 million people visit this tower's glass-floored observation deck every year.

• Ostankino Tower

This broadcasting tower was the world's first free-standing structure over 1,640 ft (500 m) tall.

• Oriental Pearl Tower

There are 11 spheres in the design of this TV tower, which has 15 observation levels.

Record-breaking buildings

The record for the tallest building (a structure that must be inhabitable) is a fiercely contested prize. These five have all won it.

• Burj Khalifa, 2010–present

This building has broken all records, including the tallest building and tallest unsupported structure.

• Taipei 101, 2004–10

The world's tallest building until the Burj Khalifa was built, Taipei 101 has 101 floors above ground.

• Petronas Towers, 1998–2004

These office blocks were the tallest buildings until 2004. They are still the tallest twin towers.

• Willis Tower, 1973–98

Formerly known as the Sears Tower, this 108-story skyscraper towers above Chicago.

• Empire State Building, 1931–72

This was the first building in the world to have more than 100 stories—it has 102. It was the tallest building for 40 years.